



HACK THE WINTER - THE SECOND WAVE

(Graphic Era Hill University (GEHU), Bhimtal)

PROJECT TITLE

SAHAYAK – An AI-Powered External Memory Companion for Alzheimer's & Dementia Patients

An autonomous, wearable AI agent that continuously Observes the environment.

TEAM DETAILS

Team Name: **PERCEVIA**

Team Members:

- Tanish Aggarwal – Team Leader
- Yash Goel
- Anshuman Dutta
- Chakshu Arora

College: Vivekananda Institute Of Professional Studies, VIPS-TC

PROBLEM DOMAIN :- **IOT & AUTOMATION**

THE CORE PROBLEM: THE "CONTEXT GAP" & LOSS OF INDEPENDENCE

Alzheimer's and Dementia are not merely about forgetting names; they strip away a person's ability to recall the narrative of life, leading to a complete loss of independence.

Patients suffer from Episodic Memory Loss, meaning they forget the context of recent events, which manifests in three specific ways:

1. Loss of Object Permanence (Short-Term Lapses):

- Patients constantly struggle with questions like "Where did I put my glasses?" or "Where are my keys?"
- This leads to anxiety and helplessness in daily tasks.

2. Social Disconnection (Prosopagnosia / Face Blindness):

- They may recognize a face but fail to recall the context: "I know him, but is he my son or my neighbor?"
- This causes social withdrawal and isolation.

3. Action & Safety Uncertainty (Visual Agnosia):

- Action Verification: Forgetting critical health tasks like "Did I already take my medicine?"
- Safety Risks: Inability to interpret objects correctly, such as confusing a bottle of cleaning fluid for a drink.



LIMITATIONS OF EXISTING SOLUTIONS:

- **Smart Speakers (Alexa/Siri):** They are connected to the internet but lack **personal context**. They can answer general facts but cannot answer personal questions like "Where is *my* wallet?"
- **GPS Trackers:** They only indicate **location** (where the user is), failing to explain **activity** (what the user is doing).
- **Reminder Apps:** These are **passive** and fundamentally flawed because they require the patient to remember to input the data first.
- **CCTV Cameras:** They provide **passive recording** without intelligence, meaning they cannot process video in real-time or answer user queries.
- **Complexity:** Many existing apps are too difficult for elderly users to navigate, whereas they need active, voice-guided assistance.
- **Symptom Focus:** Current tools only provide **alerts** rather than actually **recreating the lost memory**.



PROPOSED SOLUTION: SAHAYAK (THE EXTERNAL HIPPOCAMPUS)



3.1. HIGH-LEVEL OVERVIEW

Sahayak is an autonomous, wearable AI agent designed to function as an **"External Hippocampus"** for patients suffering from Alzheimer's and Dementia. Unlike passive GPS trackers or generic smart speakers, Sahayak actively observes the user's environment to create an **Artificial Episodic Memory**. It continuously logs "events" (who, what, when, where) and retrieves this context via voice commands to restore the user's independence.

3.2. CORE PHILOSOPHY: THE SPLIT-MODULE ARCHITECTURE

To balance high-performance AI processing with wearer comfort, the solution utilizes a unique **"Split-Design"** architecture:

- **Module A: The "Eye" (Neural Clip):** A lightweight (<40g), fabric-covered camera and microphone unit worn on the collar. It is designed to look like an accessory, not a medical device.
- **Module B: The "Brain" (Core Unit):** A processing unit (Raspberry Pi 4/5 + Battery) kept in the pocket or a belt pouch. This ensures heat and weight remain away from the user's body.
- **The Link:** A concealed ribbon cable connects the sensory "Eye" to the processing "Brain".

3.3. TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION PHASES

The development is structured in two distinct phases to ensure stability and scalability:

- **Phase 1: Prototype (Laptop-Based):** utilizes a laptop's CPU/GPU for heavy inference (YOLOv8 + CLIP) with a webcam and microphone to validate the software logic.
- **Phase 2: Wearable (Edge-Based):** Migrates the stack to a **Raspberry Pi 4 Model B (4GB)** with a Pi Camera Module 3 and **Bone Conduction Headphones** for private audio output.

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE (HARDWARE CENTRIC)

4.1. The "Split-Module" Design Philosophy

To address the challenge of running heavy AI models (like YOLO and CLIP) on a wearable device without causing overheating or discomfort, Sahayak employs a **Split-Module Architecture**. This design physically separates the lightweight sensory components (The "Eye") from the heavy processing and power components (The "Brain").

4.2. Module A: The "Neural Clip" (Sensory Unit)

- **Placement:** Worn as a magnetic clip on the shirt collar or chest area.
- **Function:** Acts as the device's "eyes and ears," capturing real-time environmental data.
- **Key Components:**
 - **Visual Sensor:** **Raspberry Pi Camera Module 3 (Wide Angle)** is used to capture high-resolution frames for the vision pipeline.
 - **Audio Input:** A **MEMS Microphone** (or USB Mic) captures natural language queries from the user.
 - **Interaction:** Features a tactile **Wake Button** allowing the user to manually trigger the system.
- **Form Factor:** Designed with a "Pebble" aesthetic and fabric cover, weighing less than 40g, to resemble a fashion accessory rather than a medical device.



4.3. Module B: The "Core Unit" (Processing Unit)

- **Placement:** Concealed in the user's pocket or a belt pouch.
- **Function:** Handles all heavy Edge AI processing, power management, and heat dissipation away from the sensitive chest area.
- **Key Components:**
 - **Compute Engine:** **Raspberry Pi 4 Model B (4GB RAM)** (or Pi 5) serves as the central brain handling offline AI inference.
 - **Power Source:** A **10,000mAh Battery** ensures 12+ hours of continuous operation.
 - **Telemetry:** Includes a **GPS Module** for location tracking and a specialized **Heat Dissipation Case** to manage thermal output.

4.4. Interconnectivity & Output

- **The Link:** A thin, concealed ribbon cable runs under the user's shirt, connecting the "Neural Clip" (Eye) to the "Core Unit" (Brain).
- **Audio Output:** The system utilizes **Bone Conduction Headphones** connected via Bluetooth.
 - *Advantage:* These sit on the cheekbones, keeping the ear canal open to ambient sounds, ensuring the user stays aware of their surroundings while receiving private audio cues

FEATURES:-

1. Contextual Social Anchor (Face + History)

- **Function:** The system identifies people and recalls the *context* of the relationship rather than just the name.
- **Output:** Instead of saying "Person Detected," it whispers, *"This is your son, Rahul. He last visited you on Tuesday"*.
- **Benefit:** Addresses **Prosopagnosia** (face blindness) and reduces social anxiety during interactions.

2. Retroactive Memory Search (The Object Finder)

- **Function:** The device passively logs the location of essential items (Keys, Wallet, Glasses) into an offline database using visual object detection.
- **Output:** When the user asks *"Where are my glasses?"*, the system retrieves the last seen location: *"I saw them 15 minutes ago on the kitchen table"*.
- **Benefit:** Solves the issue of **Short-Term Memory Lapses** and object permanence.

3. The "Reality Scanner" (Visual Question Answering)

- **Function:** Uses OCR (Optical Character Recognition) and Visual Question Answering to interpret the safety of objects.
- **Output:** Can read expiry dates or identify dangerous items, warning the user: *"This is a bottle of bleach. Do not drink it"*.
- **Benefit:** Mitigates **Visual Agnosia** and safety risks in daily life.

4. Action Verification & Logging

Function: The system tracks specific actions to verify if a task was completed.

Output: Answers queries like *"Did I take my medicine?"* with specific confirmations: *"Yes, you took the blue pill at 2 PM"*.

Benefit: Prevents accidental overdose or missed medication due to memory gaps.

5. Anxiety Reduction (Voice Cloning)

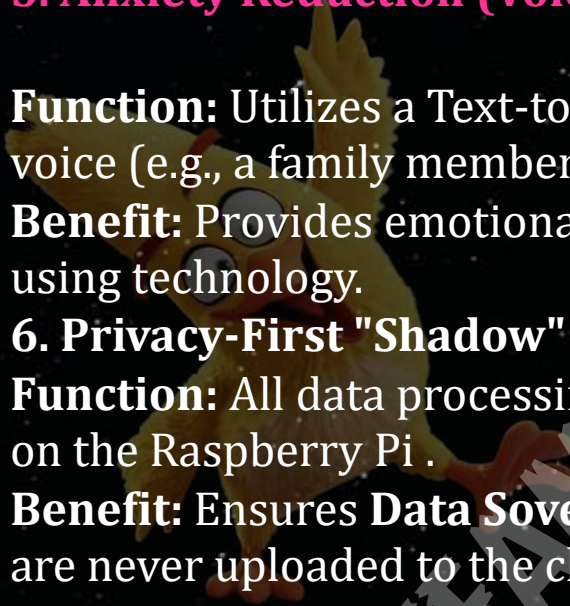
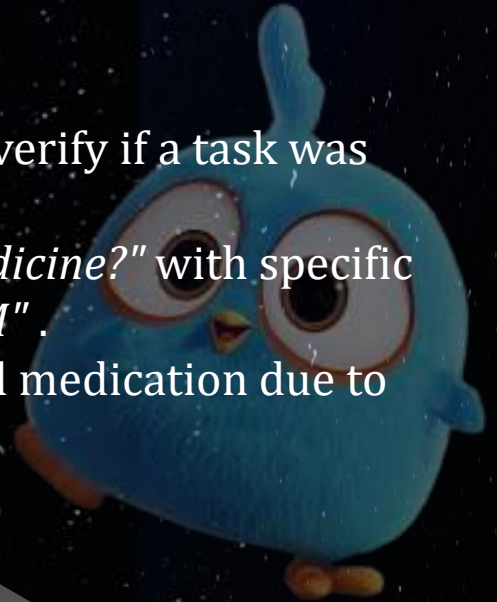
Function: Utilizes a Text-to-Speech (TTS) engine trained on a loved one's voice (e.g., a family member) instead of a robotic AI voice.

Benefit: Provides emotional reassurance and reduces the patient's fear of using technology.

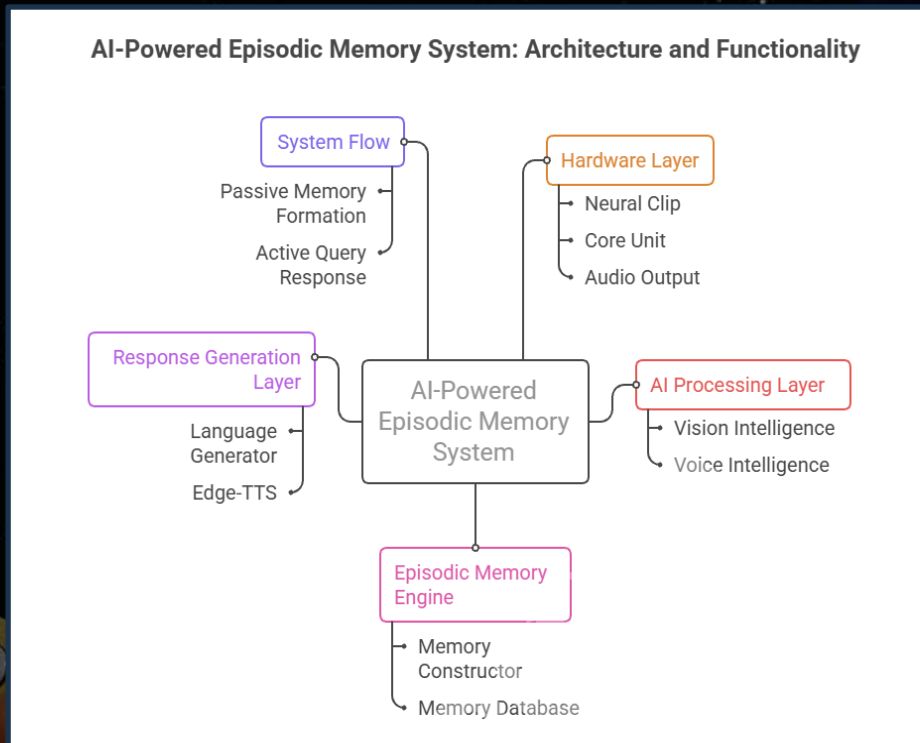
6. Privacy-First "Shadow" Architecture

Function: All data processing (Vision, Voice, Logic) happens 100% offline on the Raspberry Pi.

Benefit: Ensures **Data Sovereignty**—personal video feeds and memories are never uploaded to the cloud.



ARCHITECTURE AND WORKFLOW DIAGRAM



1. Input & Perception

Visual: The Camera continuously scans the environment (video feed).

Audio: The Microphone listens for the "Wake Word" or user commands.

2. AI Processing (The "Brain")

Object Detection: YOLOv8 identifies objects (e.g., "Keys", "Medicine").

Identity Matching: FaceNet recognizes people (e.g., "Son", "Doctor").

Contextual Understanding: CLIP verifies if the object is the *same* specific item seen before (e.g., "My specific red cup").

3. Episodic Memory Creation

Stability Check: The system confirms the object is placed (stationary) and not just moving.

Logging: It saves a structured memory log locally: {Object: "Glasses", Location: "Kitchen Table", Time: "10:00 AM"}.

4. Query Processing

User Question: User asks, "Where are my glasses?"

Speech-to-Text: OpenAI Whisper converts the voice into text.

Search: The system scans the local database for the latest entry of "Glasses."

5. Response & Action

Answer Generation: The system formulates a natural sentence: *"You left them on the Kitchen Table."*

Audio Output: Edge-TTS speaks the answer via **Bone Conduction Headphones**.

ADVANTAGES OF SAHAYAK

- Fully on-device AI
- Works offline
- Preserves user privacy
- Human-like memory recall
- Wearable & scalable
- Assistive, not intrusive

APPLICATIONS

- Alzheimer's patients
- Dementia care
- Elderly assistance
- Rehabilitation centers
- Assisted living homes

LIMITATIONS

- Limited by Raspberry Pi computer
- Accuracy depends on environment
- Requires calibration per user

FUTURE SCOPE

- Persistent memory database
- Bone-conduction audio
- Multi-language support
- Caregiver mobile app
- Cloud sync (optional)
- Emotion-aware responses

